LAEL Studio

Privacy Policy

Last Updated: August 2026

Lael Studio ("we," "our," or "us") respects your privacy and is committed to protecting the personal information you share with us. This Privacy Policy outlines what data we collect, why we collect it, how it is stored, and your legal rights in full compliance with applicable privacy regulations, including South Africa's Protection of Personal Information Act (POPIA).

1. Information We Collect

We collect information provided directly by you during project inquiries, intake forms, email exchanges, and transaction processing:

i. **Identity & Contact Details:** Full name, business name, geographic location of your business, and email address

ii. **Project & Brand Assets:** Business vision, brand guidelines, images, copy, and specific website requirements.

iii. **Financial & Payment Records:** Transaction reference IDs, deposit records, and payment confirmations processed via authorized payment gateways (e.g., Payoneer). *We never store or hold raw credit card details on our servers.*

iv. **Technical & Analytics Data:** Standard web server traffic data (IP address, browser type, operating system) collected automatically for site security and performance monitoring.

2. Purpose & Legal Basis for Data Collection

We process personal information strictly for legitimate contractual and legal obligations:

i. To execute, design, host, and deliver your requested website project.

ii. To process billing, issue receipts, and manage tax/accounting records.

iii. To register custom domain names in your legal name as authorized upon project initiation.

iv. To respond to customer support inquiries and send project status updates.

3. Data Protection & Security

i. We implement appropriate technical, administrative, and physical safeguards to protect personal data against unauthorized access, loss, alteration, disclosure, or destruction. Access to client records is strictly restricted to authorized project management personnel

4. Third-Party Sharing & Transfers

i. **No Data Selling:** We strictly do not sell, rent, trade, or lease personal data or client information to any third party for marketing or advertising purposes.

ii. **Essential Operational Providers:** Data is shared exclusively with necessary infrastructure service providers strictly to fulfil your project, specifically domain registrars (for registering your domain in your name), web hosting and cloud infrastructure platforms (for deploying and storing your website files), DNS management providers (for routing your domain traffic securely), SSL certificate issuers (for encrypting connection security), and Payoneer (for encrypted payment processing).

iii. **Legal Disclosures:** We reserve the right to disclose personal information if required to do so by law, court order, or legal process

5. Data Retention

i. Project communication and technical files are retained for the duration of the project engagement. Financial transactions and accounting records are retained securely in accordance with statutory tax record-keeping requirements.

6. Your Legal Rights (POPIA & Data Privacy)

Under applicable privacy regulations, you have the right to:

i. Access the personal information we hold about you.

ii. Request correction or updating of inaccurate personal records.

iii. Request deletion of non-essential personal information, subject to statutory record-keeping requirements.

7. Updates to This Policy

i. We may update this Privacy Policy from time to time to reflect changes in our practices or legal requirements. The updated version will be indicated by the "Last Updated" date at the top of this page.

8. Contact Us

i. If you have any questions, concerns, or requests regarding this Privacy Policy or how your information is handled, please reach out directly.

Lael Studio

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